

DID YOU REALLY SEE HER?

DON'T LOOK NOW / 1973

IN CONTEXT

GENRE

Supernatural thriller

DIRECTOR

Nicolas Roeg

WRITERS

Allan Scott, Chris Bryant (screenplay); Daphne du Maurier (short story)

STARS

Donald Sutherland, Julie Christie

BEFORE

1970 Roeg's twisted crime drama *Performance* stars Mick Jagger as a reclusive rock star.

AFTER

1976 David Bowie plays an alien in Roeg's sci-fi odyssey *The Man Who Fell to Earth*.

1977 Julie Christie is attacked by a computer in *Demon Seed*, directed by Donald Cammell.

Don't Look Now opens with the death of a child, but it's more concerned

with the fate of her parents, John (Donald Sutherland) and Laura Baxter (Julie Christie). The grieving couple relocate from their home in Britain to wintry, out-of-season Venice, where John busies himself with the restoration of a church mosaic. When Laura befriends two elderly sisters—one a blind clairvoyant—her husband begins to catch glimpses of a figure that resembles their dead daughter. Is John seeing things? Or could it be that Christine has come back from beyond the grave?

The movie poster hints at the ending without giving anything away. Like John, the audience only finds out at the end of the movie what the “warning” was all along.

What can and cannot be “seen” is the enigma at the heart of this devastating movie, whose title

